

Ask For These in FA software

- ❑ Client information
- ❑ Receivables and payables
- ❑ TDSVAT (April 2005 onwards)
- ❑ Salary payouts
- ❑ Sales and purchases
- ❑ Order management
- ❑ Inventory management (for trading firms)
- ❑ Customisability report and invoice generation
- ❑ Budgeting production
- ❑ Incorporation of items subject to different tax rates in one bill
- ❑ Technical support and after sales service

delivery *challans*, reminder services, monthly, quarterly and annual reports. If changes occur in the format of the returns, we provide free upgrades to existing users for one year."

According to Akshay Kurwa, Partner, Kurwa Rubber and Valves, Mumbai, "The rigidity that is otherwise observed in other FA packages is absent in EQA, which is very easy to operate. However, some features that I needed are yet to be incorporated. Since, we receive good after-sales support and regular upgrades, I am sure this issue will also be resolved." However, Manish Purohit, operations manger, Creadent Solutions, Rajasthan, has not been so fortunate. "Although EQA is a useful product and is packed with features, after-sales service needs to be improved. I am still waiting for the features the vendor promised."



Tally

Tally (www.tallysolutions.com) is hugely popular due to its speed, simplicity, power and flexibility. Incidentally, Tally was the first FA software to introduce the no-codes concept i.e., it accepts alphanumeric characters for accounts and inventory masters. Satish T, advisor, Tally Solutions, says, "The Tally Audit feature allows the finance manager to check the time, date and accuracy of entries. This way, malpractices can be detected and errors rectified. Tally is VAT-compliant. It is running successfully in Europe, the middle east and south-east Asia, where VAT is the norm. Implementing the same in India is not an issue."

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Vikas Chitlangia,
MD, Compubrain India
Limited (for EQA)

Various add-on features and upgrades can be downloaded from the Tally Web site. For the financial year 2005-06, Tally plans to upload VAT, e-TDS, TCS, service tax, payroll, mobile device support, multi-lingual software, portfolio management and e-banking.

Tally ees 6.3 enables exchange of information with non-Tally systems using XML, the industry standard for data interchange. It enables the user to share data across locations—with extended enterprises ("ees" stands for Extended Enterprise System) including customers, bankers, business partners and other associates. The protocol support for Tally is customised to business-specific needs and integration with SAP, Oracle and other external software is possible.

Vinod Nair, Navi Mumbai based chartered accountant has been using Tally for the last six years. "I experimented with other FA software before I settled for Tally. Tally supports good browsing speeds. The hundreds of reports that are generated daily can be easily exported to MS Excel. Unlike other custom-made accounting software that could be easily tampered with, Tally has rigid security control. Of course, for human errors such as mistakes made by accountants, only the audit trail can reveal discrepancies."



EX Personal Accountant

A product from the Tata stable, EX PA (www.myexonline.com) was created specifically for growing businesses. EX PA is enhanced by the latest technology and an extremely easy-to-use user interface. It is equipped with readymade templates to suit specific business lines. The 'Smart Folder' concept allows tracking of items/customers/suppliers and related information with a drill-down facility. EX PA has over 70 reports specifically designed to meet statutory and MIS needs. It helps perform ad hoc queries on data that make it ideal for auditing. Mr Natraj, marketing manager, TCS (Bangalore), says, "EX Personal Accountant is a user-friendly FA package and is compatible with SQL and Excel. Once the VAT formats are ready, we will upgrade the current version."



Wings Accounting

Wings Accounting (www.wings.be) was the winner in *Digit's* review of FA software in the country in July 2004. Wings Accounting offers several tools to help businesses automate their finance and accounting functions comprehensively; it can work in any world language and is also VAT-ready. It helps account for VAT payable,



Price List

Accounting Software	Price (Rs)
EQA	3,000
Wings	5,000 onward
S'Tax	10,000
Account 21	4,950 onward
Tally ees 6.3	4,500